

SYSTEM CONCEPTUAL FRAMEWORK

ATLAS Role-Based System Flow

Superuser, Administrator, Teacher, Student User, and Guest

Prepared from the current ATLAS implementation • 5 October 2026

Scope note. In this framework, “User” means the registered Student role. Teacher is shown separately because it has additional resource-management and AI-review privileges. Guest means an unauthenticated visitor using guest access.

ATLAS entry and role-routing flow

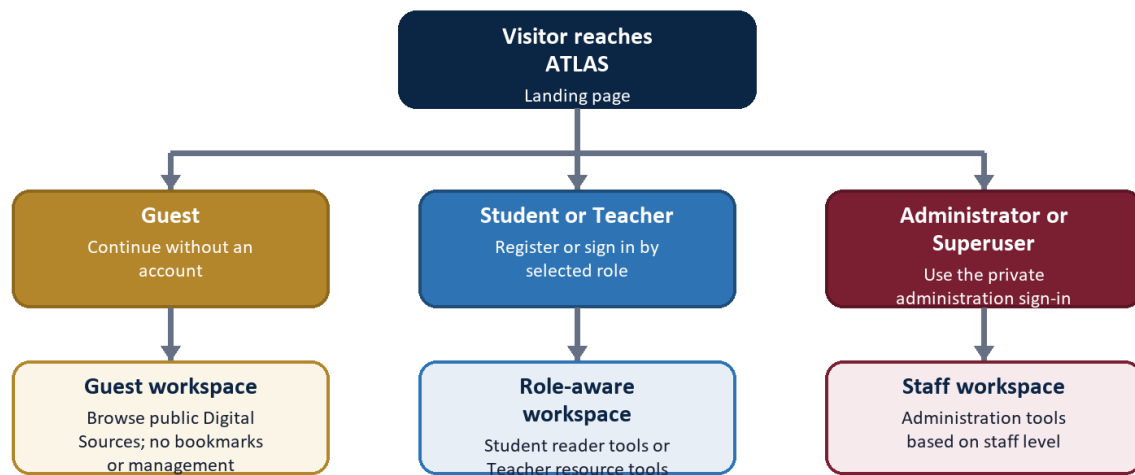


Figure 1. Entry and role-routing flow

1. Conceptual Framework

Framework logic. ATLAS receives a role and a request, validates the permitted path, performs the requested repository or administrative operation, and returns an output appropriate to that role. Every privileged branch is narrower than the branch above it unless the role is explicitly granted more authority.

Conceptual framework: Input → Process → Output → Outcome

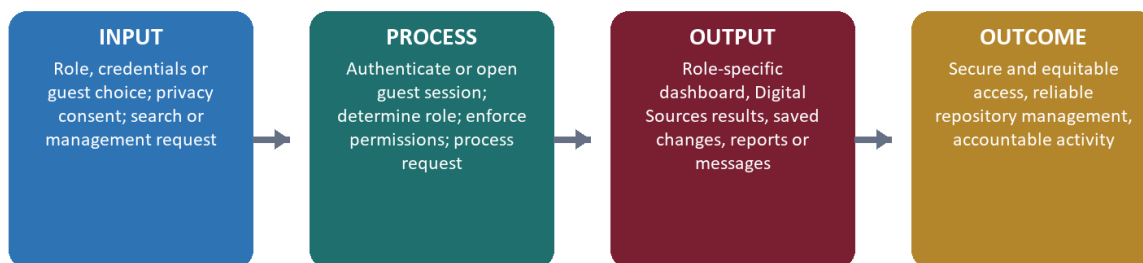


Figure 2. Input-Process-Output-Outcome model

Core control principles

1. Role-aware entry: Student and Teacher use the public role-based registration and login flow; staff use the private administration route.
2. Least privilege: Student and Guest are readers, Teacher manages resources, Administrator manages operational administration, and Superuser governs Administrators.
3. Protected reading: resource abstracts are displayed inside ATLAS; the original uploaded file is not offered as a public download.
4. Accountability: important creation, update, deletion, analysis, and administrative events can be retained for staff reporting and audit review.
5. Privacy-aware usage: signed-in activity supports institutional reporting, while anonymous guest analytics depend on the visitor's analytics consent.

Role boundaries at a glance

Role	Entry	Primary workspace	Authority boundary
Guest	Guest choice	Public reader	No bookmarks or management
Student user	Public Student login	Reader dashboard	No content or staff administration
Teacher	Public Teacher login	Reader + resource tools	No users, announcements, reports, or admin control
Administrator	Private staff login	Staff portal + admin	Cannot create/manage Administrators
Superuser	Private root login	Full staff + governance	Highest application authority

2. Guest Flow

Guest flow

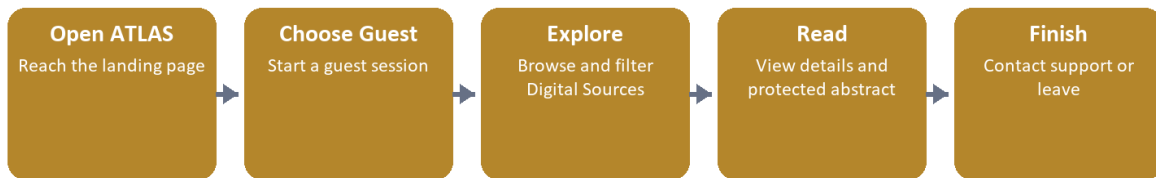


Figure: Guest workflow

Entry and identity. The visitor opens ATLAS and selects Guest. The system creates a guest session and opens the reader dashboard without requiring an account.

Main actions

6. View the dashboard and public announcements.
7. Browse, search, filter, and sort Digital Sources.
8. Open resource details, see hard-copy availability, and read the protected resource abstract.
9. Submit a support, feedback, or privacy-related contact message.
10. Choose cookie preferences; anonymous usage analytics are stored only with analytics consent.

Boundary. A Guest cannot bookmark items, manage Digital Sources, use AI Detection, open staff reports, or administer accounts.

End state. The visitor leaves the site or later chooses Student or Teacher registration/sign-in for persistent account features.

3. Student (Registered User) Flow

Student flow

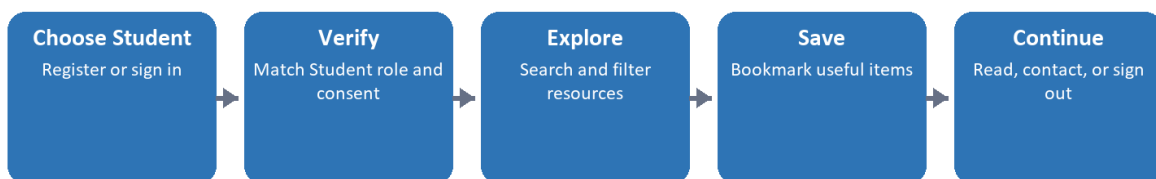


Figure: Student workflow

Entry and identity. The visitor selects Student, registers or signs in with email and password, accepts the current privacy terms, and passes role matching and email verification requirements.

Main actions

11. Use the personalized dashboard and view recent Digital Sources and announcements.
12. Search, filter, sort, and open repository items.
13. Read protected resource abstracts and check hard-copy availability.
14. Bookmark or remove resources and open the Favorites page.
15. Update account email/password settings, contact support, or submit a data-deletion request.

Boundary. A Student cannot add, edit, or delete resources; cannot use AI Detection; and cannot access staff account, announcement, reporting, or Django administration tools.

End state. The Student's bookmarks and account settings persist for the next session; signing out returns the user to the public landing page.